CYBER INCIDENT RESPONSE & FORENSIC INVESTIGATION REPORT

MANDATORY REPORTING UNDER SECTION 70B OF THE IT ACT, 2000 (CERT-IN)

Incident Ref ID: INC-2026-518	**Target Org:** PayVance FinTech India Ltd.	**Breach Classification:** P1 CRITICAL
Detection Time: 15-Mar-2026 03:12 UTC	**CISO:** Arjun Menon (+91 9845012345)	**CISO Email:** arjun.menon@payvance.io
Malware Strain: BlackByte Ransomware v3.2	**Compromised AWS Bucket:** payvance-customer-kyc-prod	**Ransom Demand:** 5.0 BTC (~$340,000)

1. EXECUTIVE INCIDENT OVERVIEW

On 15-Mar-2026 at 03:12 UTC, the Security Operations Center (SOC) of PayVance Technologies, Bengaluru, triggered emergency alerts following mass encryption of AWS RDS Aurora production clusters and exfiltration of approximately **45.2 Gigabytes** of compressed customer KYC archives from the S3 bucket s3://payvance-customer-kyc-prod. A ransom note titled BLACKBYTE_README.txt was placed on 18 internal virtual servers demanding a transfer of **5 Bitcoin (BTC)** to address **bc1qxy2kgdygjrsqtzq2n0yrf2493p83kkfjhx0wlh**.

2. INITIAL COMPROMISE & ATTACK VECTOR

Root cause analysis confirmed the initial breach originated from leaked AWS IAM credentials belonging to former contractor DevSecOps account (AKIAIOSFODNN7EXAMPLE). The threat actor connected through Tor Exit Node IP **185.220.101.5**, bypassed IP-whitelisting by pivoting through an unhardened internal EC2 bastion host (**10.0.4.15**), and executed administrative AWS CLI privilege escalation commands.

3. FORENSIC EVENT TIMELINE (RECONSTRUCTED)

Time (UTC)	Source Actor / IP	Target Resource	Action Executed	Severity
01:42:10	185.220.101.5 (Tor)	AWS IAM Endpoint	CreateAccessKey: devops_service_acc	HIGH
02:15:33	10.0.4.15 (Internal)	s3://payvance-customer-kyc	GetObject / Sync 45GB KYC Records	CRITICAL
02:48:19	185.220.101.5 (Tor)	AWS RDS Aurora	ModifyDBClusterSnapshotAttribute	HIGH
03:05:00	10.0.4.15 (Internal)	18 EC2 Production Hosts	BlackByte.exe Ransomware Execution	CRITICAL
03:12:45	CipherPhantom (Telegram)	CISO Mobile (+91 9845012345)	Extortion Demand: 5 BTC to bc1q...	CRITICAL

4. FORENSIC EVIDENCE RECOVERY & PHYSICAL HARDWARE SEIZURE

Physical inspection of the PayVance primary datacenter at Bengaluru Tech Park (GPS: 12.9716° N, 77.5946° E) uncovered a rogue network hardware implant (Raspberry Pi 4 tapping port switch ETH-04). Forensic triage of the suspect contractor workstation recovered terminal command history documenting active exfiltration scripts, GPG encryption pipelines, and the threat actor's Telegram contact handle **@CipherPhantom_BlackByte**.

5. DIGITAL EVIDENCE CUSTODY AFFIDAVIT (BSA 2023 SEC 63)

This incident dossier and accompanying SQLite triage database, network packet PCAP captures, and CloudTrail forensic logs have been cryptographically sealed under SHA-256 hash e3b0c442...9821 in compliance with Rule 12 of Information Technology (The Indian Computer Emergency Response Team and Manner of Performing Functions and Duties) Rules, 2013.

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Lead Forensic Incident Responder

CERT-In Empanelled Auditor